

Silver Maple

Acer saccharinum



Origin

Native to eastern North America, especially along rivers and floodplains, where its fast growth and flood tolerance make it well-suited to unstable soil.

Look for

Its leaves are the most deeply lobed of the common street maples, cut almost to the midrib, and the pale undersides create a shimmering, two-toned effect whenever wind moves through the canopy.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf: deeply cut lobes, nearly to the midrib -- more deeply lobed than red or Norway maple.
- Underside: pale, silvery-white, flashes in wind.
- Growth: very fast-growing, with weaker, more storm-prone wood.
- Commonly confused with: red maple (silver maple's lobes are cut much more deeply and its underside is distinctly whiter).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Small red-tinged flowers bloom very early, among the first blooms of the year.
Summer	Deeply cut leaves flash silver-white undersides in the wind.
Fall	Pale yellow color, often less vivid than red maple.
Winter	Long, drooping branch tips with narrow, pointed buds.

DID YOU KNOW

- It's one of the fastest-growing large trees in North America, but that speed comes with weaker, more storm-prone wood than slower-growing maples.
- Its winged seeds are the largest of any North American maple, sometimes over two inches long.